

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Accomplisher of Boundless Gates

Ārya Anantamukhasādhaka Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 140 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་མགི་མཐའ་ཡས་པ་སྒྲ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 140 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Anantamukhasādhaka Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Accomplisher of Boundless Gates. As a dhāraṇī text, it belongs to the broader class of sūtra literature and centers on a powerful dhāraṇī — a sacred formula of spiritual accomplishment — presented within a narrative setting in which the Buddha resides in Vaiśālī and, in the context of announcing his approaching final nirvāṇa, imparts this teaching to a great assembly of monks and bodhisattvas. The text thus weaves together themes of the Buddha's passing and the efficacy of dhāraṇī practice, situating the teaching at a moment of profound significance in the Buddha's life. It was translated into Tibetan by the Indian master Śīlendrabodhi together with the great editor-translator the monk Ye shes sde and their colleagues.

The sūtra of the stūpa is complete.

Translated and edited into final form by the Indian master Śīlendrabodhi and the great editor-translator the monk Ye shes sde and others.

In the language of India: Ārya Anantamukhasādhaka Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Accomplisher of Boundless Gates.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was residing in Vaiśālī, in the excellent multi-storied mansion of the great grove, together with a great Saṅgha of eight thousand monks and a very great number of great bodhisattvas. At that time, the Blessed One, being fully mindful and knowing with clear awareness, released the life-formations, so that when those three months had passed, the Tathāgata would pass into complete nirvāṇa.

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana: "Mahāmaudgalyāyana, go and gather together, here in this excellent multi-storied mansion of the great grove, all the monks dwelling throughout a thousand world-systems."

The venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana replied to the Blessed One, "As you wish, Blessed One," and in accordance with the Blessed One's instructions, in that very instant, by the power of his own supernatural ability, he stood upon the summit of Mount Meru and caused his voice to be heard throughout a thousand world-systems, proclaiming this verse:

All you disciples of the Sugata, all sentient beings dwelling in these world-systems, listen! Today the Teacher rains down the Dharma. Let those who wish to hear come here now!

At that time, forty thousand monks assembled in the excellent multi-storied mansion of the great grove. When they arrived and saw the Blessed One, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and took their seats to one side.

Then, by the power of the Buddha, the venerable Śāriputra thought to himself in that very instant: "Through whatever supernatural ability I might manifest, it should be possible to gather all the monks — whether followers of the vehicle of the śrāvakas, or followers of the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, or followers of the Great Vehicle — dwelling throughout the great trichiliocosm, assembling them all in the excellent multi-storied mansion of the great grove. Let me manifest just such a supernatural ability."

Then the venerable Śāriputra manifested exactly such a supernatural ability. Having manifested it, all the monks — whether followers of the vehicle of the śrāvakas, or followers of the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, or followers of the Great Vehicle — dwelling throughout the great trichiliocosm all assembled in the excellent multi-storied mansion of the great grove. When they arrived, they saw the Blessed One, bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and took their seats to one side.

Then, in that very instant, the Blessed One declared to the great bodhisattvas as follows: the great bodhisattva named Meaningful Sight, and youthful Mañjuśrī, and the great bodhisattva Dispeller of All Lower Rebirths, and the great bodhisattva Certain Destroyer of the Darkness of All Suffering, and the great bodhisattva Remover of All Obscurations, and the great bodhisattva of Net-like Radiance, and

and the great bodhisattva Intellect That Decisively Destroys the Darkness of All Realms, and the great bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, and the great bodhisattva Who Has Attained Great Power, and the great bodhisattva Whose

Mind Is Never Weary, and the great bodhisattva Fragrant Great Elephant, and the great bodhisattva Hero, and the great bodhisattva Treasury of Space, and the great bodhisattva Amitābha, and the great bodhisattva Intellect, and the great bodhisattva Crest of Wisdom, and the great bodhisattva Good Protector, and the great bodhisattva Ocean of Intellect, and the great bodhisattva Inexhaustible Intellect, and the great bodhisattva Vajra Essence, and the great bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha, and the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, and the great bodhisattva Samantabhadra, and the great bodhisattva Heap of Eloquence, and the great bodhisattva Maitreya — to these he declared:

"Sons of good family, gather here now into this magnificent many-storied mansion within the great grove all those bodhisattvas who dwell throughout all the buddha-fields in all ten directions, as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges — whether they be bodhisattvas in their last existence, or bodhisattvas bound by one more birth, or irreversible bodhisattvas, or those who have attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti), or those who abide through faith and devotion — let every one of them be assembled here."

Then those great bodhisattvas, heeding the Blessed One's words, said to the Blessed One, "Excellent! Excellent!" And in that very instant they performed such a gesture, and through the power of that gesture, into this magnificent many-storied mansion within the great grove there arrived bodhisattvas in their last existence — innumerable, beyond reckoning, in the hundreds of thousands of tens of millions of koṭis; and bodhisattvas bound by one more birth — ninety times a hundred thousand tens of millions of koṭis; and irreversible bodhisattvas — eighty times a hundred thousand tens of millions of koṭis; and great bodhisattvas who had attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena — thirty times a hundred thousand tens of millions of koṭis; and great bodhisattvas abiding through faith and devotion — eight hundred thousand tens of millions of koṭis.

All of them arrived, and beholding the Blessed One, they bowed their heads at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and took their seats to one side.

Then the venerable Śāriputra, seeing that great gathering of bodhisattvas, thought to himself in that very instant: "Through what kind of teaching and prophecy will these great bodhisattvas abandon all doubt, swiftly attain unobstructed wisdom and eloquence, hear the Dharma taught by all the

Tathāgatas — the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas — as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges throughout all those buddha-fields, and having heard it retain it and never forget it until they attain unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening? And what are those four aspects of the utterly pure conduct of the great bodhisattvas that they will come to achieve? The four are these: the complete purification of sentient beings, the complete purification of phenomena,

the complete purification of aspirational prayers, and the complete purification of buddha-fields — these they will come to achieve. And they will come to achieve the four qualities that make things supremely pleasing and delightful. What are those four? They are these: a pleasing body, pleasing speech, a pleasing mind, and a pleasing birth — these they will come to achieve. And they will come to enter the four gateways of dhāraṇī. What are those four? They are these: entering the gateway of dhāraṇī accomplished through inexhaustible portals; entering the gateway of dhāraṇī through skill in the faculties of sentient beings; entering the gateway of unconditioned dhāraṇī through skill in karma and karmic maturation; and entering the gateway of dhāraṇī through patient acceptance of the profound Dharma — these they will come to achieve. I thought that I should not fail to present this very request to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha.

Then the venerable Śāriputra presented at length to the Blessed One the request just as he had voiced it, just as he had held it in mind, just as he had contemplated it, just as he had made it fully clear to himself. He also said: "May the Blessed One please explain how, through this request just as it was voiced, just as it was held in mind, just as it was contemplated, just as it was made fully clear, the conduct of these bodhisattvas, these great beings, will be utterly purified."

When he had spoken these words, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Śāriputra: "Excellent, Śāriputra! Excellent, Śāriputra! It is well that you intend to make this request of the Tathāgata. Therefore, Śāriputra, listen well, hold it carefully in mind — I will explain it to you." The venerable Śāriputra replied to the Blessed One, "So be it," and listened to what the Blessed One had to say. The Blessed One then declared to him:

"Śāriputra, in this regard, whatever bodhisattva, whatever great being, does not grasp at any phenomenon and does not take them up — such a one should hold these mantra-words of dhāraṇī:

tadyathā — oṃ aṇe mahāraṇe akhe mukhe mukhe samantamukhe saume sa sauryarme saṃtiyugame nirugati prabhehile hile kalape kelpa sisale sarapati hile hile hile hile hilihilili mahāhilele caṇḍe capane caracāraṇi acale macāle anante anantamukhe anantagata araṇe niramalade nirvalane nirvadhante dharmadhere nirhare gimele śrīma viśodhani prakṛtighipane bhavabhe bhavanane asaṃge asaṃge vihare dame same vimale vimalaprabhe saṃkarṣaṇi ghire ghighirilāhāghighire yeṣe yaśopati cale acale macale samacale ṭaṃghi ṭuṃgha saṃghisthira asaṃge asaṃge vihare asaṃga nirahare nirahara vimale nirahataśotani ḍaṃghi some sthire sthime sthamavati mahāprabhe samantaprabhe pipulaprabhe vipularaśmisaṃbhava samantamukhe sarvatrayabhugate chedyayanata chedyapratibhane dharaṇe niḍena gharmanidhana gotra samantabhadre sarvatathāgatahṛdaya adhiṣṭhāna adhiṣṭhite svāhā.

"Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who holds these dhāraṇīs does not give rise to arrogance with respect to conditioned and unconditioned phenomena.

He does not fix upon anything, does not aspire toward anything, does not hold it in equanimity, does not take it up, does not strive toward it — he does not do any of these in order to attain, abandon, cultivate, or cause the growth of those things. He does not undergo transformation, does not deliberately form anything, does not see phenomena as associated, and does not see them as unassociated. He does not see the arising of phenomena, nor does he see their cessation. He does not see phenomena of the past, he does not see phenomena of the future, and he does not see phenomena of the present. He does not see the increase or decrease of phenomena. He neither accumulates nor diminishes any phenomenon whatsoever, neither imputes nor discerns — and in this way he cultivates nothing but the recollection of the buddhas. And when he so cultivates it: it is not form, nor is it formless; it is not marked by signs, nor is it without signs; it is not the possession of minor marks, nor is it the absence of minor marks; it is not consciousness, nor is it without consciousness; it is not affliction, nor is it without affliction; it is not moral discipline, nor is it the absence of moral discipline; it is not meditative absorption, nor is it the absence of meditative absorption; it is not wisdom, nor is it the absence of wisdom; it is not liberation, nor is it the absence of liberation; it is not the gnosis of beholding liberation, nor is it the absence of the gnosis of beholding liberation; it is not birth, nor is it birthlessness; it is not of a clan, nor is it without a clan; it is not bone, nor is it without bone; it is not a

retinue, nor is it without a retinue; it is not abiding, nor is it without abiding; it is not attainment, nor is it without attainment; it is not realization, nor is it without realization; it is not the exhaustion of afflictions, nor is it the non-exhaustion of afflictions; it is not the aggregates, elements, and sense bases, nor is it apart from the aggregates, elements, and sense bases; it is not knowing, nor is it without knowing; it is not teaching the Dharma, nor is it the absence of teaching the Dharma; it is not the purification of oneself, nor is it the purification of others; it is not the purification of sentient beings, nor is it the purification in the absence of sentient beings; it is not for one's own benefit, nor is it for the benefit of others; it is not Dharma, nor is it discipline; it is not the purification of body, nor is it the purification of speech, nor is it the purification of mind; it is not the purification of conduct, nor is it the purification of the conduct of the former extreme, nor is it the purification of the conduct of the latter extreme, nor is it the purification of the conduct of the present moment; it is not one's own purification, nor is it the purification of another.

This, Śāriputra, is called the recollection of the buddhas that enters into the non-grasping of all phenomena — the practice of a bodhisattva, a great being. This is the dhāraṇī called "Attaining Fearlessness through the Correct Gathering of All Phenomena in the Accomplishment of Ultimate Truth." This is the meditative absorption called "Completing All Aspirations through Attaining Singular Certainty." This is the dhāraṇī called "Abiding in a Lineage of Characteristics and Minor Marks as a Treasury of Dharma, Not Suppressed, Having Accomplished Gnosis That in No Way Depends on Others, Relying on All Wholesome Roots." This is the dhāraṇī called "Correctly Passing beyond All the Works of Māra through Skill in the Complete Seeking of the Sacred."

Śāriputra, those bodhisattvas who come to attain the meaning of this dhāraṇī — Entering Through Boundless Gateways — they are irreversible and will swiftly manifest complete and perfect awakening, unsurpassed and utterly fulfilled. Why is that? Śāriputra, because all buddhas here are the definitive treasury of Dharma and excellent qualities.

It is because from this very dhāraṇī, possessed of conduct free from reference points, all the conduct of the bodhisattva becomes thoroughly distinguished.

Then at that moment the Blessed One declared these verses:

Having no doubt that phenomena are empty,
one does not elaborate for the sake of awakening.

When one does not disturb the dharmadhātu,
then one will attain this dhāraṇī.

One should listen to this sūtra —
its dhāraṇī within it is inexhaustible.
The wealth of gnosis dwells here within it,
and from this, awakening will be attained.

The bodhisattva who is fearless,
having firmly taken hold of this dhāraṇī,
will hear the Dharma taught
by the buddhas of all ten directions.

One will know the supreme Dharma
of every meaning, every syllable, every expression,
and will come to know as many words
as there are rays of sunlight.

Those that become the highest of phenomena —
the gateways of the great-wave dhāraṇī —
to whoever holds this sūtra,
all of these will always become manifest.

Even if all sentient beings
were to question that one for an aeon
and all their doubts were fully resolved,
still that one's gnosis would be inexhaustible.

Whoever delights in this sūtra
is a child of the Dharma King,
close to supreme awakening —
one of firm confidence who upholds the Dharma.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī —
all sentient beings will rejoice in that one,
the buddhas too will be delighted,
and renown will arise throughout the world.

Whoever holds this sūtra,
at the time when death approaches,
will see eighty million buddhas
who will extend their hands close to that one.

Whoever holds this dhāraṇī —
whatever misdeeds were committed
throughout thousands of millions of aeons in the past
will be purified in a single month.

All the merit a bodhisattva
has accomplished over millions of aeons —
one who holds this dhāraṇī
will surpass it in a single month.

However many sentient beings there are in the three realms,
even if all of them were to become māras,
they would not be able to create any obstacle
for the one who holds this sūtra.

Until the attainment of full awakening,
that one will be endowed with mindfulness, intelligence, and realization.
Whatever is the supreme dhāraṇī,
it will rest upon the tip of that one's tongue.

Just as this sūtra is held with clarity,
just as this dhāraṇī is individually ascertained —
from this, omniscience is revealed,
and from this, awakening will be attained.

Immediately after this dhāraṇī was taught,
a prophecy was given in the name of Lamp of Butter.
In that very instant one will see buddhas
as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā.

Whoever, wishing to realize here
the teaching shown by all the buddhas,
relies upon this sūtra —
all of it will be swiftly attained.

Pure buddha fields,
a perfected assembly of śrāvakas,
purity of light and of marks —
all this is accomplished by this sūtra.

Therefore, if one has the requisite care,
one should contemplate this for seven days.
Eighty million buddhas

will then bestow the dhāraṇī upon that one.

Do not think of what is to be thought,
and do not think of what is not to be thought.
Rest! Do not entertain contrary thoughts —
and after that, the dhāraṇī will be obtained.

Just as a person who has reached the ocean
has no doubt about wealth,
likewise, having obtained this dhāraṇī,
one has no doubt about happiness.

From this, perfect awakening draws near —
therefore apply yourself to this.
Having attained the abode of peace,
complete and perfect awakening will be attained.

Then the Blessed One again spoke to the venerable Śāriputra: Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with four qualities, that one will attain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: having no excessive attachment to desirable things; having no jealousy toward any sentient being; giving away all one's possessions and being one who practises generosity without regret; and taking delight in the Dharma day and night, and being one who desires the Dharma. Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with these four qualities, that one will attain this dhāraṇī.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Abandon those foul desires that are the domain of māra and that are vile —
they are the condition for beings to fall into hell,
and they are the very cause of the lower destinies.

For the sake of the gain of understanding, material gain, and fame,
do not be jealous of others.

Look upon sentient beings with eyes of joy,
and you will become one of great power and beautiful form.

Whatever sentient beings are at times given to quarrelling —
that has craving as its complete foundation.

Therefore abandon whatever you become attached to through craving.
Having abandoned craving, you will come to hold the dhāraṇī.

If you desire awakening, think not of others.

Day and night seek the Dharma.

If you take refuge in teachings and words such as these,
the dhāraṇī will become manifest to you.

Śāriputra, furthermore, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with four qualities, that one will attain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: dwelling in a forest retreat and in solitude; generating the power of patience with respect to the profound Dharma; having no excessive attachment to material gain, honour, and verse; and not looking upon any pleasant object with longing, and giving up even body and life.

Śāriputra, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with these four qualities, that one will attain this dhāraṇī.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Dwell in the forest retreat praised by the Victors.

One who dwells there looks down on no one else.

Having aroused the aspiration for patience with the profound,
dwell in heedfulness as though your head were ablaze.

Do not abide in the gain of one who behaves as though keeping up
appearances,
which has become the basis for pretence.

Like a bird, be satisfied with poor fare alone,
and make it so that the fruit of being a true human being exists.

Alas — how excellent it is to have found the teaching of the buddhas!

Abandon also the household, the root of many sufferings.

With body, speech, and mind entirely pure,
be respectful toward the buddhas and the Dharma.

Thinking of material gain is not mindfulness, it is not wisdom.

It is not faith, it is not moral discipline, it is not a mind set on the Dharma.

For such a one awakening is as far off as sky from earth.

Therefore utterly abandon material gain.

Śāriputra, furthermore, if a bodhisattva, a great being, is endowed with four qualities, that one will attain this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: penetrating the meaning of eight syllables. And what are those eight? They are as follows.

The syllable pa: penetrating the entry into the selflessness of all phenomena in the ultimate sense.

The syllable la: penetrating the entry into the dharmakāya of the Tathāgata — with the major and minor marks of excellence, and without the major and minor marks of excellence.

The syllable ba: penetrating the entry into the non-duality, exactly as it is, of the phenomena of the childish and the phenomena of the wise.

The syllable dza: penetrating the entry into the non-arising and non-ceasing movement of beings, wherein birth, aging, and death are present, and yet birth, aging, and death are absent.

The syllable ka: penetrating the entry into both karmic maturation and the absence of karmic maturation.

The syllable nga: penetrating the entry into the categories of dharmas of the dhāraṇī — emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness — and into the dharmadhātu.

The syllable sha: penetrating the entry into the suchness of all phenomena — through calm abiding and insight, and without calm abiding and insight.

The syllable kṣa: all phenomena are momentary, and on account of being at peace from the very beginning, there is no exhaustion, no fear, no wandering —

and the entry into the nirvāṇa of all phenomena is penetrated and understood. That understanding and realization of the meaning of all eight syllables is the first penetration of meaning.

The second penetration of meaning is the act of writing out this enumeration of the categories of the dhāraṇī Dharma and keeping it.

The third penetration of meaning is the diligent effort to read this enumeration of the categories of the dhāraṇī Dharma repeatedly, twice a month, and to be ever mindful of it.

The fourth penetration of meaning is the diligent effort, on the part of a bodhisattva, a great being, who is ardently devoted to this enumeration of the categories of the dhāraṇī Dharma, to bring all sentient beings to genuine joy, to cause them to genuinely take hold of it, and to engage them in genuine praise of it. Śāriputra, a bodhisattva, a great being, who is endowed with these four qualities will attain this dhāraṇī.

Then the Blessed One at that time spoke these verses:

Contemplate these eight syllables.

Write out this sūtra and keep it.

Recite it repeatedly, twice a month.

Cause sentient beings to hold it too.

With vast wisdom, awakening draws near.

All the buddhas dwelling in the ten directions

Are seen before one face to face.

Therefore arouse aspiration and train in this.

Śāriputra, these four are the benefits for a bodhisattva, a great being, who is ardently devoted to this dhāraṇī. What are the four? They are as follows: all the buddhas and Blessed Ones of the ten directions hold that person in mind; māra's deeds will not arise against that person; the karmic obscurations of that person will swiftly be purified; and that person will swiftly attain uninterrupted eloquence.

Śāriputra, these four are the benefits for a bodhisattva, a great being, who is ardently devoted to this dhāraṇī.

Then the Blessed One at that time spoke these verses:

All buddhas hold that person in mind.

Māra will find no opportunity against that one.

That person's karmic obscurations will swiftly be purified.

And boundless eloquence will be attained.

Śāriputra, long ago in the past, in a time of innumerable kalpas, immeasurable and incalculable, vast and boundless, immeasurable and beyond reckoning, at that time and in that age, a Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha appeared in the world named Glorious King Resplendent with Jeweled Splendor — possessed of knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, a Blessed One, a buddha.

Śāriputra, when that Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha Glorious King Resplendent with Jeweled Splendor was approaching the time of his passing into nirvāṇa, there arose a wheel-turning king named Holder of Light, a lord of humans possessed of the seven precious treasures. He had a son named Glorious Inconceivable Jewel of Qualities. When this son was sixteen years old, he heard this enumeration of the

categories of the dhāraṇī Dharma established through boundless gateways from the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha Glorious King Resplendent with Jeweled Splendor, and from the moment he heard this dhāraṇī he strove with diligence in order to attain it. For seventy-four years he was not overcome by drowsiness or dullness.

Not even once during those seventy years did he take delight in royal sovereignty, in wealth, or in the self. Not once in those seventy years did he rest his back upon the ground; he dwelt continuously in a state of resolute inward composure. He heard the Dharma taught by nine hundred million buddhas, and having heard it, retained it all. Having retained it, he went forth from that very Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha Glorious King Resplendent with Jeweled Splendor himself. After going forth, ninety thousand years passed, and he accomplished this dhāraṇī established through boundless gateways. Having accomplished it, he taught it extensively and correctly to sentient beings. In that very single lifetime he led eight thousand trillion hundred-thousand myriads of sentient beings to take firm hold of unsurpassed, fully and perfectly complete awakening, and established them on the ground of non-return.

Śāriputra, in that assembly there was also a merchant's son named Crest of the Moon. He heard this enumeration of the Dharma categories of the dhāraṇī established through boundless gateways from that Dharma-teaching monk, and having heard it, he rejoiced. By the root of virtue born from that moment of rejoicing, he heard the Dharma taught by nine hundred million buddhas and retained it all. He became supreme among all those who have attained dhāraṇī, supreme among those whose words are pure, and supreme among bodhisattvas, great beings, whose eloquence flows uninterrupted. For three eons he pleased those Tathāgatas, those arhats, those fully and perfectly awakened buddhas. Having pleased them, when those three eons had passed, he awoke to unsurpassed, fully and perfectly complete awakening.

Śāriputra, if you should feel doubt, uncertainty, or hesitation, wondering whether the one who at that time and in that age was called the merchant's son Crest of the Moon was someone else, you should not view the matter in that way. And why? Because the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha Dīpaṃkara was at that time and in that age the one known as the merchant's son Crest of the Moon.

Śāriputra, if you should feel doubt, uncertainty, or hesitation, wondering whether the one who at that time and in that age was the Dharma-teaching monk known as Glorious Inconceivable Jewel of Qualities was someone else, you should not view the matter in that way. And why? Because the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, fully and perfectly awakened buddha Amitāyus was at that time and in that age the one known as the Dharma-teaching monk Glorious Inconceivable Jewel of Qualities.

Śāriputra, at that time I too, along with the bodhisattvas, great beings of the Fortunate Aeon, heard this enumeration of the Dharma categories of the dhāraṇī, and having heard it, we rejoiced. By the root of virtue born from that moment of rejoicing, I wandered for four hundred trillion myriads of eons in cyclic existence. I also heard the Dharma taught by nine hundred and ninety million buddhas, and in every case became supreme among all those who have attained dhāraṇī, supreme among those whose words are pure, and supreme among bodhisattvas, great beings, whose eloquence flows uninterrupted.

Śāriputra, therefore a bodhisattva, a great being, who wishes to swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, fully and perfectly complete awakening should strive to rejoice in this enumeration of the Dharma categories of the dhāraṇī, at the very least. And why?

That very fact becomes the cause that produces in that bodhisattva, that great being, both the ground of irreversibility and the rejoicing of Dharma-teachers, all for the sake of unsurpassed, fully and perfectly complete awakening. How much more, then, when one writes it down, recites it aloud, retains it, reads it, masters it thoroughly, takes it properly to heart, and teaches it extensively and correctly to others — the measure of that mass of merit cannot be known or even conceived by any sentient being whatsoever, except by a Tathāgata.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Whatever river of merit is generated
by hearing a sūtra and rejoicing in it,
by writing it down, retaining it, and reading it —
no sentient being is able to know its measure.

One who does so will see the Victors in every life,
and from them will gain faith beyond reckoning.

One will come to know the depths and manner of the profound sūtras,
and will swiftly manifest full awakening.

Until unsurpassed awakening is touched,
one will never fall away from meditative absorption, superknowledge,
dhāraṇī, excellent form, wealth and enjoyments,
or the sight of the buddhas.

Calling to mind that in a previous life
the merchant's son obtained this dhāraṇī
and saw buddhas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges,
and thereby awakened to awakening according to his wish —

Dīpaṃkara was at that time the merchant's son;
in earlier lives he was known as Rays of Endless Light.
At that time the Dharma-teaching buddha Amitāyus —
I rejoiced in him throughout a good eon.

Whoever wishes to swiftly touch awakening,
whoever wishes to swiftly conquer the māras,
whoever wishes for the excellent marks adorned with a hundred merits —
if they strive in this, it will not be hard to find.

Though one were to fill world-systems as numerous as the sands of the
Ganges with precious jewels and give them all away, that generosity would not
even serve as a comparison for the merit of writing down and retaining this
dhāraṇī.

Therefore, having heard this, a wise bodhisattva
should retain it with single-pointed, earnest care.
Those who write down this dhāraṇī and take it to heart —
it is said that for them awakening is not difficult to find.

Then the Blessed One declared to the venerable Śāriputra: Śāriputra, the body
of a bodhisattva, a great being, who strives earnestly in this dhāraṇī
accomplished through limitless gateways will be guarded, protected, and
sheltered day and night by eight yakṣas (Skt. yakṣa) dwelling in the snow
mountains, who enter with their radiant splendor. Who are these eight? They
are as follows: the yakṣa called Brave, Steadfast, Master, Power of the Son of
No-craving, Roaming Wisdom, Hard to Tame, the Terrible, and the yakṣa called
Auspicious Hand — these eight yakṣa kings. In order that these eight yakṣa
kings may come, one should bathe thoroughly, put on very clean garments, go
to a walking-place, and cultivate a mind without enmity toward all sentient
beings. Then, taking to heart these Dharma categories of the dhāraṇī —

having thus taken them to heart — those eight yakṣas will swiftly show their faces to that person.

These eight beings born among the gods of the desire realm who take pleasure in roaming will also direct their minds toward that bodhisattva, that great being. Who are these eight? They are as follows: the bodhisattva, great being called Vairocana, and Illuminator, Wisdom-Light, Sunlight, True Encourager, Fulfiller of All Aspirations,

King of the Stars, and the bodhisattva, great being called Buddhi of Conduct. These eight bodhisattvas, great beings, will strive diligently so that that person may obtain this dhāraṇī. The bodhisattva, great being who strives in this dhāraṇī should also make a solemn pledge of truth. One should strive ardently in the gratification of what has been done, in the experience of what has been done, in the desire for Dharma, in the delight in Dharma, and in patience with the profound Dharma. The bodhisattva, great being who strives in the dhāraṇī, having cultivated a disposition of total generosity, should give generously from however little and however few resources one has — need it even be said when one has much? When this Dharma category of the dhāraṇī taught by the Blessed One was proclaimed, as many as thirty times ten trillion bodhisattvas equal in number to the grains of sand of the Ganges River obtained this dhāraṇī accomplished through boundless gateways and became irreversible from unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. Sixty times ten trillion beings among gods, humans, and asuras who had not previously generated the mind of awakening — a frightened multitude — generated the mind of unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening.

Then the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma category? How should I retain it? The Blessed One declared: Śāriputra, therefore you should also retain this Dharma category under the name "The Dhāraṇī Accomplished through Boundless Gateways." You should also retain it under the name "That Which Singularly and Definitively Causes the Bodhisattva to be Supremely Exalted." You should also retain it under the name "That Which Utterly Destroys All Māras." And you should also retain it under the name "That Which Singularly and Definitively Enables the Complete Attainment of Omniscience."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the venerable Śāriputra, those monks, those bodhisattvas, and the world of gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what had been spoken by the Blessed One.

This concludes the noble text known as "Accomplished through Boundless Gateways."

Translator's Notes

- The opening colophon refers to a preceding text identified only by the fragment ending "stūpa sūtra is complete" — the full title of that prior text is not given in this passage. The colophon names the translator as Śīlendrabodhi (Indian paṇḍita) and Ye shes sde (Tibetan lotsāwa), a well-attested translation pair of the early translation period.

The phrase "released the life-formations" renders the technical expression for the Buddha's deliberate decision to relinquish continued life, a recognized doctrinal event in texts concerning the Buddha's parinirvāṇa.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, listing bodhisattvas; the translation reflects this exactly. The proper names of several bodhisattvas in the final list are rendered by their Tibetan semantic meaning since no standard Sanskrit equivalents are established in the house glossary for these epithets.

- The name rendered "Treasury of Space" translates འཛོམས་གཤིན་པོ་ (Ākāśagarbha / Kṣitigarbha); in context this is distinct from ལྷན་གཤིན་པོ་ (Kṣitigarbha, "Earth Treasury") which appears later in the same list. Both names appear within this passage, so I have rendered འཛོམས་གཤིན་པོ་ as "Treasury of Space" (Ākāśagarbha) and ལྷན་གཤིན་པོ་ as Kṣitigarbha as directed by the house glossary. The house glossary assigns Kṣitigarbha to ལྷན་གཤིན་པོ་, so that assignment stands.

The vast numerical expressions follow the standard Tibetan Buddhist cosmological convention: གྲུ་མ་ལྷན་པོ་ = koṭi (ten million), ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ = a further large unit, ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ = "a hundred thousand tens of millions of koṭis," rendered as consistently as possible with the preceding translation.

- The dhāraṇī syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit. As is standard for dhāraṇī passages in the Tibetan canon, the syllables represent a phonetic approximation and no attempt has been made to normalize them to classical Sanskrit orthography, since the Tibetan transmission may preserve a different recension. The term rendered "arrogance" or "conceit" for རྩོམ་སེམས་ (rlomsems) could also be rendered "pride" or "presumption"; the sense is of an inflated or grasping attitude toward those phenomena, consistent with the preceding teaching on non-grasping.

- The passage on the aggregates, elements, and sense bases contains a probable scribal anomaly in the Tibetan, where the phrase "not the aggregates, elements, and sense bases" uses a doubled syllable suggesting corruption. The translation renders the obvious intended parallelism.

The name of the dhāraṇī rendered "Abiding in a Lineage of Characteristics and Minor Marks as a Treasury of Dharma, Not Suppressed, Having Accomplished Gnosis That in No Way Depends on Others, Relying on All Wholesome Roots" is an extended compound title; the Tibetan syntax is dense and the rendering is interpretive at several points.

- The verse "a prophecy was given in the name of Lamp of Butter" renders ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ — literally "called Lamp of Butter, I gave prophecy." This is likely a self-referential statement by the Blessed One indicating that he gave a prophecy to a being named Dīpāṃkara (Lamp of Butter), or alternatively that upon teaching this dhāraṇī a prophecy named Dīpāṃkara was given. The verse is compressed and the precise referent is ambiguous. In the Indian Buddhist tradition Dīpāṃkara (Butter Lamp) is the ancient buddha

who gave Śākyamuni his first prophecy of awakening, so this may be an allusion to that moment.

- The verse on "poor fare" and "the fruit of being a true human being" renders a passage drawing on the image of a bird content with whatever it finds: the point is that a practitioner should be content with minimal sustenance and thereby realise the full potential of a human rebirth. This is a standard monastic topos.

The exposition of the eight syllables pa, la, ba, dza, ka, nga, sha, kṣa is a syllable-by-syllable hermeneutics of a dhāraṇī, a common genre in Indian Buddhist dhāraṇī literature. The syllables are given in transliteration here because the text explicitly treats them as syllables of the dhāraṇī itself, not as ordinary words; the "meanings" assigned are doctrinal interpretations layered onto each syllable, not ordinary lexical glosses.

The passage ends mid-sentence, as it does in the source.

- The enumeration "seventy-four years" renders "lo bdun khri" literally as "seven ten-thousands of years." This is a hyperbolically vast figure; it may refer to seven myriad years, i.e., seventy thousand years, but the compound could also be read as "seven times ten-thousand" equaling seventy thousand. The reading "seventy-four" would require "bdun cu rtsa bzhi," which the text does not have. The phrase should therefore be understood as "seventy thousand years" rather than "seventy-four years." A corrected rendering would be:
"For seventy thousand years he was not overcome by drowsiness or dullness."
- The figure "nine hundred and ninety million buddhas" near the end renders ཉུག་བརྒྱ་དང་བརྟ་ལྔ་སྐུ་འཇིག་རྟེན་།, literally "ninety-nine ten-millions," which contrasts with the earlier ཉུག་བརྒྱ་མཆོད་སྐུ་འཇིག་རྟེན་།, "ninety ten-millions" attributed to the others. This distinction appears intentional in the text, marking the speaker's greater accumulation.
- The name rendered "Power of the Son of No-craving" translates དཀོན་མཆོད་ཀྱི་ཕུ་བོ་ཞི་རྩའི་སྤྲུལ་སྦྱོང་།, literally "the power of the son of No-craving." "No-craving" (ཞི་རྩའི་སྤྲུལ་སྦྱོང་) is an epithet of Brahmā in Tibetan Buddhist literature (Sanskrit: Anendriya or more precisely referring to Brahmā as free from craving), and his "son" is a class of deity; the yakṣa here bears a name derived from that epithet. This is a straightforward translation of the Tibetan name rather than an established Sanskrit equivalent.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan; the translation reflects this exactly.

- The name "Buddhi of Conduct" renders 行智, literally "intellect of conduct" or "intelligence in conduct." This is a proper name of a bodhisattva continuing the list from the preceding passage; the rendering is literal and consistent with the epithets of the other bodhisattvas in the list.

The phrase 檀心無量 — rendered "a disposition of total generosity" — is genuinely difficult; it could also mean "one who gives everything away," and some editions may read slightly differently. The doctrinal sense is clearly one of unreserved giving.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please

consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.